



The Louise E. Toussaint Foundation

Artist's Grant Application

Biographical Information

Name: Celestine Broussard	Location: Bywater, New Orleans, LA
Have you ever applied for a LET Grant before?	☐ YES ☒ NO
Are you a full-time Louisiana resident?	☒ YES ☐ NO

Portfolio Information

Please attach photos or copies of representative works with your application.

Title of piece(s):

Personal Statement

Please make sure that your statement answers each of the following questions in the space provided below. You may answer them in any order you wish, and you may attach additional pages as necessary.

Who or what are some of your greatest inspirations?

What makes you an artist?

Why should LET choose you for this grant opportunity?

While my sources of inspiration vary widely, the majority of them hail from my home city of New Orleans. From the vibrant colors of Ida Kohlmeyer to the folk art of Sister Gertrude Morgan, I have found inspiration throughout. I once heard that an artist never feels at peace. If that's true, then I have always been an artist. I've had the hunger since my first breath. It was big, too big for Beau Marais. I had to feed it, so I ran away—like an old story I read about a man who came back from war a beast. Gnashing his teeth, he tore away from his house and was never seen again. Just like him, I couldn't tell you how or why I had to run. I just did it. I'll never forget the look on my mother's face when I grabbed my suitcase and stormed off the front porch. I didn't understand why she didn't understand. "Watch yourself, baby," she said. "God don't like ugly, and you reap what you sow." Back then, I thought it would be easy. I'd go far away and start over. But now I know you can never start over. The roots might hide in the soil, but they stretch for miles and miles. Once I found this truth, my art changed forever. I started layering my past into my work, looking at my life under a different lens. Then I finally